General Comments

Two questions in particular, numbers 12 and 16, proved to be difficult and were not answered well. The two questions mentioned highlighted the importance of reading the question carefully before attempting to answer. In general the questions involving applications of chemistry in industry and every day life were the ones least successfully answered.

Comments on Individual Questions

Question 6

The incorrect answer **C** was almost as popular as the correct answer **B**. The most likely reason being a failure to appreciate the importance of the charges on each of the hydrogen ions.

Question 7

The key word in the stem of the question was gaseous and of the elements mentioned in the question only graphite, carbon, forms a gaseous oxide.

Question 13

Almost fifty percent of the entry chose the incorrect alternative **C**. The significance of the word reverse in the stem of the question having been missed by the candidates.

Question 15

The most common questions on the reaction between calcium carbonate and hydrochloric acid involve how the volume of carbon dioxide given off varies with respect to time. Over sixty percent of the entry answered the question from the perspective of the volume change and not, as required, from the perspective of rate change.

Question 27

The three incorrect alternatives attracted in total over sixty percent of the candidates with each alternative being equally popular. This emphasises once again the importance of reading the stem of the question with great care.

Question 29

All of the properties of aluminium given in the question were correct properties of aluminium. The key to the correct answer was that only alternative A referred to an alloy of aluminium.

Question 31

This question involved simple recall of a quote in the syllabus. Bacterial decay of plants was given as the answer by many candidates. Unfortunately whilst compounds of nitrogen are given off by bacterial decay of plants the oxides of nitrogen are not included in these compounds.

General Comments

Two questions in particular, numbers 12 and 16, proved to be difficult and were not answered well. The two questions mentioned highlighted the importance of reading the question carefully before attempting to answer. In general the questions involving applications of chemistry in industry and every day life were the ones least successfully answered.

Comments on Individual Questions

Question 5

The incorrect answer **C** was almost as popular as the correct answer **B**. The most likely reason being a failure to appreciate the importance of the charges on each of the hydrogen ions.

Question 7

The key word in the stem of the question was gaseous and of the elements mentioned in the question only graphite, carbon, forms a gaseous oxide.

Question 12

Almost fifty percent of the entry chose the incorrect alternative **C**. The significance of the word reverse in the stem of the question having been missed by the candidates.

Question 16

The most common questions on the reaction between calcium carbonate and hydrochloric acid involve how the volume of carbon dioxide given off varies with respect to time. Over sixty percent of the entry answered the question from the perspective of the volume change and not, as required, from the perspective of rate change.

Question 28

The three incorrect alternatives attracted in total over sixty percent of the candidates with each alternative being equally popular. This emphasises once again the importance of reading the stem of the question with great care.

Question 29

All of the properties of aluminium given in the question were correct properties of aluminium. The key to the correct answer was that only alternative A referred to an alloy of aluminium.

Question 30

This question involved simple recall of a quote in the syllabus. Bacterial decay of plants was given as the answer by many candidates. Unfortunately whilst compounds of nitrogen are given off by bacterial decay of plants the oxides of nitrogen are not included in these compounds.